



STRATFORD-UPON-AVON

The best place to find out more about the Bard's life is to visit his hometown. Here you can view the house in which he was born, the farmhouse belonging to his wife's family—Anne Hathaway's cottage—the school he attended, and the church floor under which he was buried. You can also see Shakespeare's plays brought to life at some of Stratford's fine theaters, such as the Royal Shakespeare Theater (above) and the Other Place.

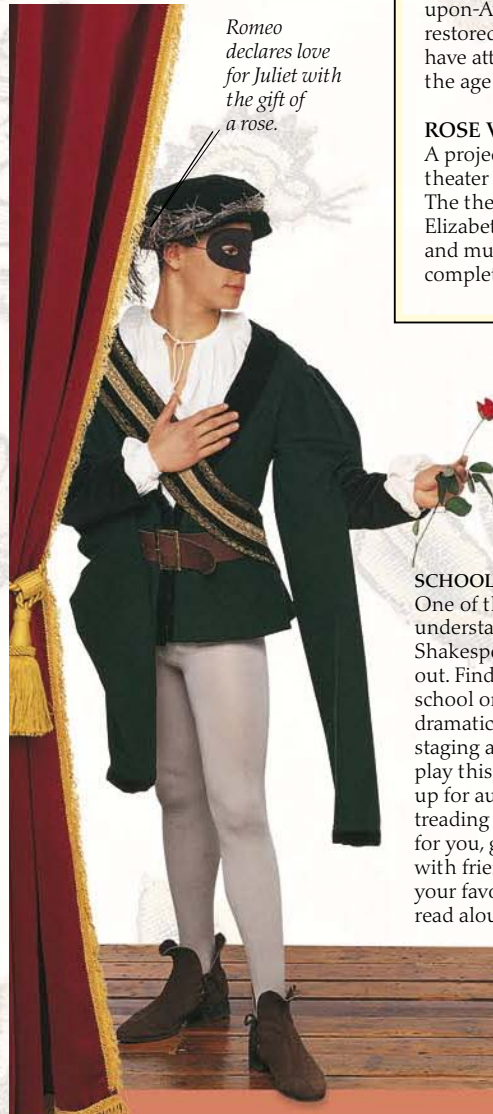
Every detail reflects the number three, symbolizing the Holy Trinity

An Elizabethan triangular lodge in Northamptonshire, England



ELIZABETHAN HISTORY

Discover more about Shakespeare by investigating the age in which he lived. Historically, the Elizabethan era was very significant and much remains to be studied today. Temporary exhibitions at your local museum may cover the military, literary, or fashionable aspects of Elizabeth's reign. Look for examples of Elizabethan architecture, which was amazingly intricate. Beautiful ornamental gardens were popular in the Elizabethan age, and some are still preserved and thriving today.



Romeo declares love for Juliet with the gift of a rose.

Places to visit

STRATFORD FESTIVAL OF CANADA, STRATFORD, ONTARIO

Every year from April through November, Shakespeare's plays are the main events at the Stratford Festival of Canada. Visitors can also attend concerts, discussions, readings, and performances of plays by other celebrated playwrights.



Pupils at Stratford Boys' Grammar School in the 1960s

UNDERGLOBE, THE GLOBE, LONDON, ENGLAND

Underneath the Globe theater is a vast exhibition space dedicated to the historical era in which Shakespeare lived. Using interactive technology and traditional crafts, every aspect of Shakespeare's realm is brought to life in thrilling detail.

STRATFORD BOYS' GRAMMAR SCHOOL, STRATFORD-UPON-AVON, ENGLAND

The King Edward VI Grammar School in Stratford-upon-Avon dates back to the 13th century and is fully restored and in operation today. Shakespeare would have attended this school for several years from about the age of seven.

ROSE VILLAGE, MASSACHUSETTS

A project to build a replica of the original Rose theater of Elizabethan London is underway. The theater will be surrounded by a village of Elizabethan-style buildings containing exhibitions and museums. Construction is due to be completed in 2007.

School production of *Romeo and Juliet*



SCHOOL PLAYS

One of the best ways to understand the plays of Shakespeare is to act one out. Find out if your school or any local dramatic societies are staging a Shakespeare play this year and sign up for auditions. If treading the stage is not for you, get together with friends and choose your favorite scenes to read aloud.